

Introduction

In Assignment 2 of the Human-Computer Interaction course, we will be conducting heuristic evaluations on the prototype that has been designed by Group 7 in Project Part 4 as part of the progression for the project in general. Here, we will apply Nielsen's heuristics to evaluate the designed user interfaces while rating them with the severity level based on observation.

Nielsen's Heuristics consists of 10 rules:

1. Visibility of system status. – Necessity of real-time information providing
2. Match between system and the real world. – Familiarity of the System to the user
3. User control and freedom. – Multifunction application
4. Consistency and standards. – Design matches expectations and is consistent
5. Error prevention. – Warning triggers for certain actions
6. Recognition rather than recall. – Recognition of Pages allows easier access
7. Flexibility and efficiency of use. – Shortcuts and efficient solutions to problems
8. Aesthetic and minimalist design. – Consideration of button design relevancy
9. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors. – Let the user understand what went wrong
10. Help and documentation. – Guides and information given to user

Severity Rating:

1. Cosmetic Issue
2. Minor Issue
3. Major Issue
4. Catastrophic Issue

Through the identification of issues of their Figma prototype using these rules, we will be able to revise the designs and improve them to fit societal expectations hence inviting more users to our application upon launching.

Method of evaluation

We will be carrying out the evaluation process by splitting roles among the group members. All 5 members will understand Heuristic Evaluation and then each test the Figma prototypes one by one. We will then gather all opinions from each group member to decide the violations existing in Group 7's application design and proceed to revise the design, based on the 10 rules by Nielsen's Heuristics. The result of the updated design will then be used to test on random users for further insights.

Prototype:

The Figma prototype designed by Group 7 in Project Part 4, is a website prototype designed to simplify the job search process for a diverse range of users, including individuals with disabilities, international job seekers, and local job seekers. This prototype focuses on offering an inclusive, user-friendly experience with features specifically tailored to the unique needs of each user group, improving accessibility and facilitating the discovery of employment opportunities both locally and globally.

Description of Persona:

Jayne Woo, a 24-year-old accounting graduate from Johor, Malaysia, who faces physical disabilities, is renowned for her strong work ethic, passion for accounting, and proficiency in Excel.

Scenario:

Jayne encounters challenges in her job search due to companies' concerns about her disability and the lack of accessibility features on job search websites, such as poor interface design, small fonts, and the absence of a read-out feature.

Goal:

Jayne aims to find a job in accounting by exploring local and international positions and improving her job search experience by changing language settings and advocating for more accessible website features.

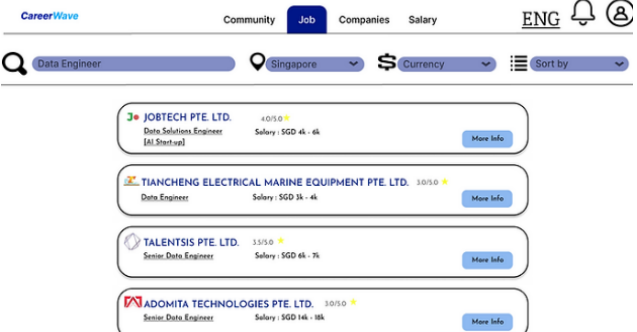
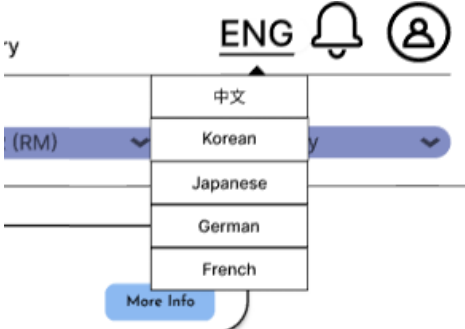
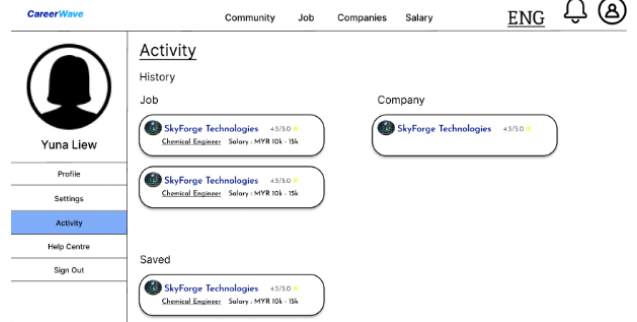
3 User Tasks

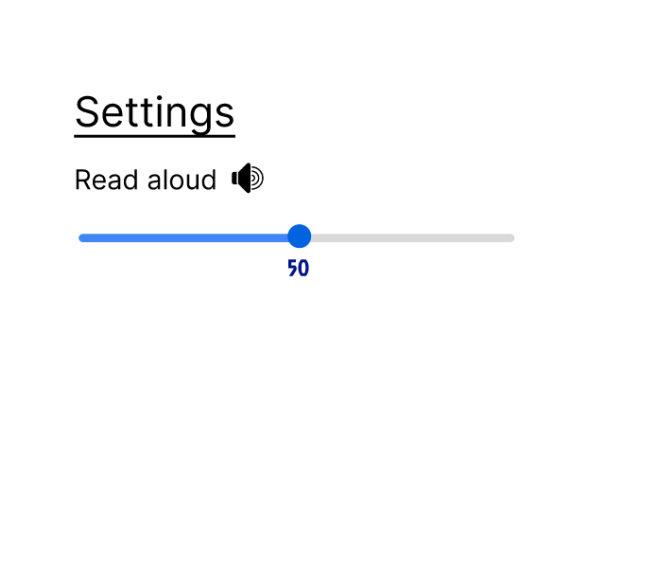
- i. Explore a Local Job Relates to the User's Interest or Current Field of Work
- ii. Find An International Job or Job from another Country Exclude Malaysia
- iii. Change the language settings of the website

Three main user tasks were assigned to evaluate the application/website design based on the Figma prototype, aiming to further improve and enhance the system's design and reduce existing flaws. Based on the feedback gathered from these tasks, we used the results as a reference to conduct the Heuristic Evaluation, as shown in the table below.

HE Table

No	Prototype Image	Identified Issue	Heuristic and Severity
1		The icons at the top right of the screen such as language, notification, and profile do not have accompanying text labels. This may confuse users as they might not immediately recognize their functions.	H6: Recognition rather than recall S3: Major issue
2		There is no easy way for users to navigate back to the previous page which is the Job page.	H3: User control and freedom S3: Major issue
3		The font used in the page making it hard to see the differences between the information. The light colour used on the page makes the interface difficult to read	H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design S3: Major issue

4		No specific country is stated for each job on the main page of the job lists.	H6: Visibility of system status S3: Minor Issue
5		The website does not remember the user's preferred language, the user must reset it every time they visit the website.	H1: Recognition rather than recall S3: Major issue
6		No scrolling feature to allow users to navigate and interact with the website, user may feel restricted.	H3: User control and Freedom S3: Major issue
7		After clicking this button, the user cannot choose the sorting method themselves, but the system automatically sorts. This can lead to user confusion as to what the current sort is showing	H4: Consistency and standards S4: Usability catastrophe

8		The slider ranger can only be retraced after reaching the maximum value and only a specific value can be selected (0,50,100). This can make users feel restricted.	H3: User control and Freedom S3: Major issue
9		The “Apply” button is still there after applying for the job and might confuse the user to whether they had applied or not.	H1: Visibility of system status S3: Major issue
10		After choosing the preferred language, other jobs located in the list beside the main job details page haven’t changed to chosen language.	H4: Consistency and standards S3: Major Issue

User Journey Map



Jayne Woo is a 24-year-old emotional accountant that passionate in accounting. She has a strong work ethic and proficiency in Excel and is a person with disability

Scenario: Jayne encounters challenges in her job search due to companies' concerns about her disability and the lack of accessibility features on job search websites, such as poor interface design, small fonts, and the absence of a read-out feature.

Goal: Jayne aims to find a job in accounting by exploring local and international positions and improving her job search experience by changing language settings and advocating for more accessible website features.

Explore a local job relates to user's interest or current field of work	Find an International job or job from other country exclude Malaysia	Change the language settings of the website
1.Navigate to Job Search Page 2.Enter Job Search Criteria 3.Browse Job Listings 4.View Job Details 5.Apply for the Job I wonder if I can find local job related to accounting here Why is it hard to understand these icons Why the "Apply" button still here after I apply Oops now I realize I could scroll to see more Ugh, why I can't back to previous page	6. Switch Job Search criteria to international 7. Adjust Read-Out feature This like that I can search international job too. I wish I can change the website's colour and font because it is difficult for me to read, let me try the read-out feature How are these jobs sorted? It's confusing. I hope I can straight away see the country on the main page of job list Did I already apply for this job?	8. Decides to switch the language to Chinese 9. Verify language change I'm so happy that I can choose my preferred language Good website but could be better with some improvements Why the jobs list beside the main job didn't change to Chinese Why the website can't remember my preferred language when I accidentally refresh
Recommendations: 1. Add text labels below each icon to indicate their function. (Issue 1) 2. Add a "Back" button to the job details page. (Issue 2) 3. Improve readability by using a darker font colour and increasing the contrast between text and background. (Issue 3) 4. Provide scroll indicators to let users know they can scroll to see more. (Issue 6)	Recommendations: 1. Create a drop-down menu to allow the user to choose the sorting method. (Issue 7) 2. Optimize the slider ranger so that the user can freely adjust the volume to any value. (Issue 8) 3. Update the user by changing the status of "Apply" to "Applied" after successfully applying. (Issue 9) 4. Include country information next to each job listing to improve the visibility of system status and provide clear information to users. (Issue 4)	Recommendations: 1. Improve the consistency of the chosen language so that users can better understand the content. (Issue 10) 2. Use the user profile to save the preferred language. (Issue 5)

